



Abanti Sankaranarayanan, Executive Vice President for Public Policy, Mahindra & Mahindra

out in the public domain its overall sustainability vision and philosophy, which it calls 'Planet Positive.' Second, it is also able to continuously engage in informed discussions with stakeholders, including investors, customers, the supply chain and communities. "The third is in terms of operational decision-making," Sankaranarayanan adds.

One of M&M's most notable CSR initiatives was the 'Jal Samridhi' project, for which the Group won 'Best CSR Initiative Impact' at the National Excellence Awards in 2024.

Notably, in the past year, the farm

division of M&M received the 'Brandon Hall Group Gold Award' and 'Best Initiative for Philanthropy and Corporate Giving' for its CSR initiatives. The initiative, titled Project Hunnar, focused on livelihood generation through farm mechanisation.

According to Sankaranarayanan, the project helped empower rural communities by enhancing their skills in tractor operation and tractor-mounted farm equipment usage across multiple states.

The CSR programme, says Sankaranarayanan, helped M&M understand and run skill development and income generation programmes in multiple geographies under the same theme, i.e. mechanisation, as well as to get a good representation of women into the programme.

The automobile-to-technology conglomerate has also received reasonable assurance for BRSR (Business Responsibility And Sustainability Reporting) Core disclosures mandated by the Securities and Exchange Board of India for the top 1,000 listed companies in India.

Preparing for external validation through the BRSR Core involved several measures. Firstly, bringing internal data management systems to a level of robustness that would enable the group to make sure that it can accurately disclose as per requirements. "We conducted extensive internal audits before we had the external validation through third-party assurance providers. And then, finally, we had a huge amount of cross-functional mobilisation of effort and collaboration across departments because of the wide-ranging and diverse metrics that are to be captured in BRSR," says Sankaranarayanan. It became a group-wide mobilisation, he adds. **BT**

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M&M HAS
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